Danny **Yu**

Technical Support · Troubleshooting, Classroom Technology & Systems

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October 22, 2026

Hiring Committee
Client Services, Surrey IT Services
Simon Fraser University

Re: Service Desk Agent, Surrey IT Services

Dear Hiring Committee,

I'm applying for the Service Desk Agent position at the Surrey campus. For the past five years I have worked inside an SFU faculty unit, Science Alive in the Faculty of Applied Sciences. My role there is to keep teaching technology working for the people who rely on it: instructors running a room, curriculum writers, and the students and families on the other end. A service desk is the same work for the whole campus, and I'd like to do it on your team.

Most of my troubleshooting happens in classrooms. A camp or school workshop is thirty devices sharing one network connection, often on slow wifi, with an instructor who needs it working in the next five minutes. I teach in those rooms (Python, web development, Arduino, LEGO robotics), so I have diagnosed hardware, software, and connectivity problems live, in front of a class. When something breaks, I work through it methodically: reproduce it, narrow it down, fix it, then write it down so the next person doesn't hit it.

I also support the staff who use the systems I run. Six curriculum writers sign in with their SFU accounts to **campkit**, the curriculum platform I built, and camp instructors publish student work through **spark-gallery**, which handled 509 projects from 416 campers over the summer. Most of these users are not technical, so I design the steps around them: a link and a printed instruction sheet instead of software to install. When they get stuck, I'm the person they contact, and I explain the fix in plain language. After camp I write to parents directly, sending each family their child's code and programs with step-by-step instructions for running them and continuing the work at home.

My Computer Engineering degree and two co-ops give me the technical base. As a developer in test at Global Relay and a QA intern at Incognito Software, my job was to find out exactly why something failed and report it clearly. I also set up a Docker and Jenkins testing environment, so I'm comfortable with servers, configuration, and logs.

I want to be direct about the gaps. I have not worked a ticketed service desk, and I have not maintained lecture-theatre audio-visual systems. The habits carry over: triage by impact, keep clear notes on every case, and follow up until it's resolved. I learn new systems quickly, and I would learn your tools and procedures the same way.

Because my users are children, privacy is designed in from the start: real names never reach repositories, databases, or backups. I would bring that same care to student, faculty, and staff accounts. Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about the role.

Sincerely,
Danny Yu

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Summary

Technical support and systems person with an SFU Computer Engineering degree, two QA and test-automation co-ops, and five years in an SFU faculty unit. I keep classroom technology working for instructors and students, and I run and support the web systems our staff use, including a curriculum platform behind SFU sign-in. Methodical troubleshooter, clear communicator with non-technical users. I build with Claude Code and make the architecture, data, privacy, and operations decisions myself.

Skills

Troubleshooting	Classroom devices and networks, hardware (Arduino, LEGO SPIKE, Raspberry Pi), user accounts and sign-in, web applications
Systems & tools	Linux, git, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Cloudflare, SQL (SQLite / D1)
Languages	Python, JavaScript, HTML / CSS, Java
Support	Plain-language instructions and documentation, staff onboarding, testing and bug reporting

Work Experience

SFU Science Alive (Faculty of Applied Sciences Outreach)
Burnaby, BC

School Programs and Instructional Lead
Jun. 2021 – Present

- Teach coding and robotics camps and school workshops (Python, web, Arduino, LEGO robotics), keeping a room of student devices working on shared, often slow, school networks.
- Support the program's staff on the systems I run: six curriculum writers on **campkit** (SFU sign-in via Cloudflare Access), and camp instructors publishing through **spark-gallery** (509 projects from 416 campers over one summer).
- Designed workflows for non-technical users: uploads from the camp room through a link and a printed instruction sheet, with no software to install.
- Communicate directly with parents: send each family their child's code and programs with written, step-by-step instructions for running them and continuing at home.
- Operate **hello-wattson** (hellowattson.ca), the public lesson site for 20 programs and 54 lessons that students use on classroom devices, with a nightly automated rebuild that keeps program dates current.
- Protect personal data by design: student names pseudonymized before reaching repos or backups, and location data stripped from photos and video.
- Authored SPARK, the program's workshop-design framework.

Global Relay
Vancouver, BC

Software Development Engineer in Test (Co-op)
Jan. 2023 – Aug. 2023

- Diagnosed API failures by building a Java tool that validates service responses against expected results.
- Built test stubs (Thrift, Wiremock) and a single source of truth for regression tests using the Trino REST API.

Incognito Software Systems Inc.
Vancouver, BC

QA Engineer Intern
Jan. 2022 – Aug. 2022

- Wrote automated GUI tests in Java and Selenium and maintained a regression test schedule.
- Set up a Docker and Jenkins continuous-testing environment.

Projects

ChessMate: A Smart Automated Chessboard
Burnaby, BC

SFU ENSC Capstone
Jan. 2024 – Aug. 2024

- Built the human-move detection module with a Raspberry Pi camera and OpenCV, comparing board states to identify the moved piece; drove an electromagnetic trolley in Python to execute the machine's moves.

Education

Simon Fraser University
Burnaby, BC

BASc in Computer Engineering
Graduated 2025